

Organisational change

Change management guideline 2018



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Executive summary

The various industrial instruments that apply to the Department of Health and Hospital and Health Services (Queensland Health), their employees and unions provide specific consultation obligations governing organisational change.

All proposed organisational change needs to demonstrate clear benefits such as enhanced service delivery to the community, improved efficiency and effectiveness and is subject to consultation with employees and their unions.

The consultation obligations require the exchange of timely information relevant to the issues at hand so the parties have an actual and genuine opportunity to influence the outcome before a final decision is made.

Breaching Queensland Health's consultation obligations may result in unnecessary delays in implementing proposed changes and have significant negative industrial outcomes including disputation conducted through the Queensland Industrial Relations Commission.

Queensland Health in consultation with unions, has compiled this guide to assist work areas which may be considering implementing organisational change.

This guide and appendixes contain information on:

- considering change and meeting industrial obligations.
- preparing a business case for change including necessary documentation.
- consultation processes with employees and unions on proposed change.
- preparing a proposed implementation plan for change including necessary documents.
- implementing change.

Introduction

Change in the workplace is necessary to ensure health services are responsive to user's needs and sustainable into the future. Organisational change may arise from the need to review and change the service delivery/model of care in response to changes in government policy or variations to the way services are funded.

If a review or trial is required, it is often helpful to discuss with management, colleagues, other Health Services and unions who may have faced similar issues. If a review or trial is being considered consultation with directly affected employees and their relevant unions must occur from the outset.

Consultation with directly affected employees and their relevant unions must occur consistent with the relevant industrial instruments regardless of whether the proposed change is "significant" or not. Any proposed change that is likely to have 'significant effects' on employees requires the provision of a business case.

When embarking on an organisational change process, it is recommended to liaise with your respective HR unit for guidance.

This guide is designed to ensure compliance with industrial instruments.

Key principles

Any organisational change should be cognisant of the following:

- employment security for permanent employees is maximised.
- there will be early and detailed planning to support all proposed workforce change to ensure workforce impacts are handled fairly and consistently.
- open and timely employee, union and stakeholder communication and engagement are essential throughout the process.
- all affected employees are supported with assistance programs.
- employee information is treated with sensitivity.
- case management (where required) may include placement, (re)training and development, providing meaningful duties, identifying suitable alternative roles and assisting the employee if unsuccessful after applying for roles in accordance with the relevant Public Service Commission directive
- voluntary redundancies may be considered should employees advise of their interest
 - The [Government Employment Security Policy](https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy) (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy>) outlines

Cabinet approval is required for all major organisational change and restructuring that will result in:

- a) significant impact on the government workforce (e.g. significant job reductions, deployment to new locations, alternative service delivery arrangements etc.).
- b) major social and economic implications, particularly in regional and rural centres where the government is committed to maintaining government employment.

Considering change

Consideration of any change may initially involve informal discussions with relevant key stakeholders including directly affected employees and their relevant unions. These discussions may provide insight to the matters and generate options that could lead onto a review or for inclusion into a business case. There must be an actual proposal that has been developed before that proposal can be taken to employees and their relevant unions for consultation.

Queensland Health recognises the cultural diversity, rights, views and expectations of Aboriginal peoples and Torres Strait Islander peoples in the delivery of culturally appropriate health services. Proposed organisational change to Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander health services should identify community representation as a key stakeholder to assist in empowering the community on the appropriate provision of health services.

If conducting a review or trial of any aspect of service delivery likely to impact on employment, Queensland Health must consult the directly affected employees and their relevant unions from the outset.

All proposed organisational change will need to demonstrate clear benefits such as enhanced service delivery to the community, improved efficiency and effectiveness and are subject to consultation with employees and their unions. Specific considerations are to be made in respect to operational stream employees under the provisions of cl 6.4.2 [EB9](https://gheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements) (<https://gheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements>) with no contracting out, leasing or outsourcing of operational services during the life of the agreement.

Any proposed change that is **likely** to have 'significant effects' on employees requires the provision of a business case to the Health Consultative Forum (HCF) or equivalent. Developing the business case need not be an onerous process. (See Appendix 1 Guide for preparing a Business Case for change and Appendix 2 for the Business Case Template).

gheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/employment-conditions/change-management-guidelines

Where the change is **not likely** to have a significant effect on employees, a business case is not required. However, employees and unions are to be consulted on the reasons behind the change and options that may be considered to implement the required change.

An engaged workforce supported by an inclusive strategy can affect the change more efficiently.

Significant effects include *'major changes in the composition, operation or size of the employer's workforce or in the skills required; the elimination or diminution of job opportunities or job tenure; the alteration of hours of work; the need for retraining or transfer of employees to other work or locations and the restructuring of jobs'*.

The following are some examples which may be considered significant organisational change:

- reduction of positions.
- potential increase in workload of directly affected employees.
- changes to hours of work (e.g. Introduction of shift work or changing business hours).
- employees requiring placement.
- changes in core business or organisational structure.
- changes to workforce composition.
- significant changes in work practices or model of care (e.g. potential increase in workload).
- voluntary redundancies.
- significant change in primary work location.
- significant changes to funding that will impact on the workforce.
- contracting out of new or existing services.
- major social or economic implications at regional and rural centres.
- mapping of existing employees to different job roles.
- revised service delivery methods.
- reassignment of customer or client groups.

Further guidance should be obtained from your local HR business partner.

Queensland Health consultation requirements

Successful change involves consultation and cooperation with all parties involved, including management, employees and union representatives. Consultation is not an empty term and is never to be treated as a mere formality. Consultation adds value to business decision making and can identify opportunities and help ensure new ideas work effectively in practice.

Consultation provisions within industrial instruments require that directly affected employees and relevant unions be provided relevant information and have a sufficient opportunity to express their views and influence the outcome before any final decision is made or course of action embarked upon. Examples where consultative processes are required include, but are not limited to, restructuring or contracting out or service delivery changes. All parties will participate in a constructive manner.

Joint union and employer consultative committees, such as Health Consultative Forums (HCFs), are one of the primary mechanisms for consultation with employees at the local level and are vital for the implementation of industrial instruments within Hospital and Health Services.

Unions usually request a consultation period of at least 2 weeks to engage and consult with employees about the impacts of proposed change.

General consultation procedures to be followed for all organisational change

- Consult with the workforce and unions from the outset on the potential for change
 - Observe the [Queensland Government's Contracting-out of Services Policy](https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/contracting-out-services-policy) (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/contracting-out-services-policy>)
 - Observe the [Queensland Government's Employment Security Policy](https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy) (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy>)

Additionally, where the change is likely to have significant effects on employees:

- develop and present a business case at the HCF or equivalent forum
- refer the proposals to your local Human Resources unit and relevant peak consultative groups where required. Peak consultative groups include BEMS SBU, EB9IG/PHOC, HPDOCG, MOCA4OC and NaMIG.

When consulting in the workplace, remember to respect everybody's opinions and backgrounds. Depending on your workplace you may need to take into account employee's capacity to make sure everybody understands the consultation process.

Contracting out

Proposals to contract out other services are to be developed in accordance with a business case addressing the reason for change and is to be developed in accordance with [Queensland Government's Employment Security Policy](https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy) (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy>) by demonstrating clear benefits and enhanced service delivery. There shall be no contracting out, leasing or outsourcing of operational services currently provided by operational stream employees (cl 6.4.2 EB9 (<https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreement>)).

Queensland Health must ensure relevant unions are provided with relevant documents and consulted on any proposal to contract out or lease current services as early as possible and before any steps are taken to call tenders. The [EB9 \(https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements\)](https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements) and [BEMS6 \(https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements\)](https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements) certified agreements require tenders to ensure contractors maintain certain provisions such as paying wage rates which are no less favourable in aggregate, than previous EB rates of pay for comparable employees. Proposals to contract out existing functions may also require referral to the relevant peak consultative group.

In cases of critical shortages of skilled staff or extraordinary or unforeseen circumstances, information must be provided at the next relevant peak consultation group meeting to assist in determining strategies to resolve issues that arise.

Proposed contracting out arrangements in circumstances of a lack of infrastructure capital or the cost of providing technology, or where it can be demonstrated it is in the public interest, cannot occur until agreement is sought from the relevant peak consultative group.

If, after full consultation, employees are affected by a necessity to contract out or lease current services, the employer must:

- negotiate with relevant union/s employment arrangements to assist employees to move to employment with the contractor;
- ensure that employees are given the option to accept deployment or redeployment with Queensland Health
- ensure that employees are given the option to take up employment with the contractor; and
- ensure employees are offered a voluntary early retirement, only as a last resort.

It is the policy of the government that if the conditions of the existing contract allow for the contract to be renewed without a tendering process, and the external provider has met all the conditions of the contract, a new contract may be offered to the current provider subject to continuing commercial viability and the mutual agreement of both parties.

Further detail is provided in relevant within the relevant industrial instruments 'Contracting' provisions.

Introducing change

Following the provision of a business case and consideration of feedback, a decision may be made to introduce change. Upon deciding to introduce change, further consultation requirements are triggered which include the provision of a proposed implementation plan and associated documents for consultation with directly affected staff and relevant unions on:

- the likely effects of the changes on employees; and
- the period over which the change is to occur; and
- ways to avoid or minimise the effects of the change/s.

Appropriate job reduction strategies will be developed that may include non-replacement of resignees and retirees and the deployment/redeployment and retraining of excess employees which will have regard to the circumstances of the individual employee/s affected.

See Appendix 3 Implementation Plan Guide and Appendix 4 Implementation Plan Template on QHEPS at: <https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/employment-conditions/change-management-guidelines>

Documentation requirements

The following tables outline the mandatory documents required at each stage of the significant organisational change process:

Business case

Document	Comments
Business case To staff and unions (See Appendix 1 & 2)	A business case is required for significant change, restructuring, or other change that will impact on the workforce. (See Section 2 'Considering Change' for what may be considered significant organisational change.)
Current Organisational structure To staff and unions	Both must clearly show classification levels, position titles, position numbers and reporting lines. (Employee's names are not included)
Proposed Organisational structure – new To staff and unions	

List of Affected staff To unions only	A list of affected staff will be provided by the employer to the relevant unions so that consultation can occur with those affected staff. Affected staff includes employees who will be directly impacted, as well as employees who may be impacted by changes.
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Proposed implementation

Document	Comments
Implementation plan (proposed) To staff and unions (See Appendix 3 & 4)	Key information includes: - proposed timetable for implementation of the change/s, commencing from the time the decision of change is announced and including planned communications. - information about how the positions in the new structure are being proposed to be filled (e.g. limited applicant pool suitability assessment where there are more staff than positions or capability assessment etc). - availability of employee support mechanisms (e.g. employee assistance program, resume/interview workshops, superannuation sessions, etc). - how feedback was reasonably considered
Affected positions spreadsheet (See Appendix 5) (proposed) To staff and unions	This spreadsheet must contain a full list of all positions directly affected by the change/s and new roles that will be created. Further, details of how the positions identified in the "new" structure are to be filled must be included (e.g. limited applicant pool suitability assessment).
Current Organisational structure To staff and unions	Both must clearly show classification levels, position titles, position number and reporting lines. (Employee's names are not included)
Proposed Organisational structure – new To staff and unions	
Role descriptions To staff and unions	Role descriptions are required for new roles or those being altered. Management is reminded to ensure any such role

	descriptions are evaluated and endorsed according to the applicable process prior to release.
List of Affected staff To unions only	A list of affected staff will be provided by the employer to the relevant unions so that consultation can occur with those affected staff. Affected staff includes employees who will be directly impacted, as well as employees who may reasonably be expected to be impacted by changes.

Final Implementation Plan

Document	Comments
Implementation plan (Finalised) To staff and unions	Key information includes: - timetable for implementation of the change/s including planned communications. - information about how the positions in the new structure will be filled (e.g. limited applicant pool suitability assessment where there are more staff than positions or capability assessment etc). - availability of employee support mechanisms (e.g. employee assistance program, resume/interview workshops, superannuation sessions, etc). Copies of the documents below are also to be provided if they differ from those provided with the proposed implementation plan.
Affected positions spreadsheet (See Appendix 5) (proposed) To staff and unions	This spreadsheet must contain a full list of all positions affected by the change/s and new roles that will be created. Further, details of how the positions identified in the "new" structure are to be filled must be included (e.g. limited applicant pool suitability assessment).
Current Organisational structure To staff and unions	Both must clearly show classification levels, position titles, position number and reporting lines. (Employee's names are not included)
New Organisational structure To staff and unions	
Role descriptions	Role descriptions are required for new roles or those being altered. Management is reminded to ensure any such role

To staff and unions	descriptions are evaluated and endorsed according to the applicable process prior to release.
List of Affected staff To unions only	A list of affected staff will be provided by the employer to the relevant unions so that consultation can occur with those affected staff. Affected staff includes employees who will be directly impacted, as well as employees who may reasonably be expected to be impacted by changes.

Resources

Document	Comments
Implementation flowcharts	Flowcharts can be an effective method of communicating the various implementation stages.
FAQs	Assists by placing key questions and answers in one easy to read format, and ensuring messages are clearly and consistently communicated to staff.
Letter templates	Standard letter templates to assist management. The need to customise or create new templates is likely to arise depending upon the particular circumstances.
Meeting prompts/scripts	It is recommended that where information is conveyed orally (e.g. staff meetings, individual meetings, etc) an outline of key messages is developed to guide the officer delivering the message, and to ensure accuracy and consistency.
Website	In order to maximise opportunities for employees to access relevant and timely information regarding the change, it may be beneficial to create a dedicated intranet page containing some of the key documentation.

Appendix 1

A guide for preparing a business case Organisational change

Overview

A decision for change may be as a result of strategic or operational requirements and must be in accordance with the Queensland Government's Employment Security Policy (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy>). A business case is a key component in securing commitment for a change initiative and facilitating constructive stakeholder feedback. Although the level of detail provided in the business case will depend on the scale, scope and complexity of the change, it must appropriately demonstrate the clear benefits such as enhanced service delivery to the community, or improved efficiency and effectiveness.

The business case must address an actual proposal rather than an abstract idea and no implementation should occur until the business case has been subject of consultation with relevant unions and those directly affected employees. The business case may also provide information relating to the chosen strategies to appoint to positions if known at the time (for example, a limited applicant pool suitability assessment process where there are more staff than positions).

There shall be no contracting out, leasing or outsourcing of operational services currently provided by operational stream employees (cl 6.4.2 [EB9](#)) (<https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements>). Proposals to contract out other services are to be developed in accordance with a business case addressing the reason for change and the Queensland Government's Employment Security Policy.

As part of the consultation process managers must prepare the following mandatory documents:

- proposed business case for significant change.
- current organisational structure, which identifies numbers and classifications of employees engaged.
- new organisational structure, showing numbers and classifications of employees in the future.
- list of affected staff will be provided to the relevant unions so consultation can occur with those affected staff.

What is a Business Case?

A business case is a formal document outlining a proposal - from beginning (what issue or situation triggered the initiative) to end (what benefit, value or return is expected). Queensland Health has obligations under various industrial instruments to provide both a business case and a reasonable opportunity for employees and unions to discuss and provide feedback on proposed change/s.

No business case is required for minor organisational change or minor restructuring. E.g. job reclassification, job redesign involving process re-engineering, minor changes in work practices and the introduction of new technology.

When do I need to prepare a Business Case for change?

A Business Case is required for all significant organisational change that will significantly impact on the government workforce (e.g. deployment to new locations, job reductions, alternative service or delivery arrangements including those which are to be introduced on a trial basis). (See Section 2 'Considering Change' for what may be considered significant organisational change or when a business case may be required).

Although a business case is not required for minor changes or minor restructuring, consultation is required with directly affected employees and relevant unions.

Who requires a copy of the Business Case once developed?

A copy of the business case proposing change is to be made available to those directly affected employees and relevant unions for consultation. During a specified period of consultation, affected employees and relevant unions will be provided the opportunity to provide feedback on the options available and the likely effect of change. This feedback must be considered as part of the change process and incorporated where necessary.

For change that will have a significant impact on the workforce, a business case is to be tabled for consultation at the Health Consultative Forum (HCF) or equivalent. The majority of these forums meet regularly and include representatives of the relevant unions as members and usually keep minutes of the issues discussed.

What else should I consider when developing a Business Case for change?

Employment Security - A business case addressing the reason for change is to be developed in accordance with [Queensland Government's Employment Security Policy](https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy) (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy>) by demonstrating clear benefits and enhanced service delivery to the community. This policy also clearly establishes the Queensland Government's commitment to maximum employment security for permanent government employees and temporary employees with an emphasis on minimum disruption to the workforce and maximum placement of affected staff.

Consultation Considerations - Ensure the consultation process is suitable for the affected workforce, in that it should be respectful and take into account cultural and language differences. Where information is provided and feedback is sought, always ensure this is accompanied by reasonable timeframes that allow the opportunity for genuine feedback to be provided.

All feedback should be reasonably considered and a response provided. It is important to demonstrate the feedback was considered as part of this process and the reasons for acceptance or rejection of feedback.

Who is your audience? - Once this is established ask the following questions:

- does this person understand the environment and background of the proposal?
- what information will this person be looking for?
- what impact is the proposal or initiative going to have on this person?
- how could this person influence the direction of the proposal or initiative?
- what does this person need to see in order to support or endorse the proposal or initiative?

Business case for change template – A business case for change template (Appendix 2) is available to support the process of preparing a Business Case for change.

Background

The introduction/background describes the history and current situation related to the issue or opportunity. The purpose is to provide direction at the beginning of the document about what the proposal will achieve if the business case is supported. It should include relevant information such as service delivery expectations, costings, legislative changes or summary of current business processes.

A business case for proposed change should substantiate the proposal for significant change/restructuring e.g. deployment to new locations, job reductions, major alterations to current services or delivery arrangement. A business case **must address an actual proposal rather than an abstract idea**.

A business case can be a key component in facilitating a commitment for a change initiative through meaningful consultation with stakeholders about the proposal.

No implementation should occur until the proposal contained within the business case has been subject of relevant consultation with directly affected staff and relevant unions.

Reason for Change (Issue)

Demonstrate the reason for change with sufficient detail including:

Why is a change required? What factors are influencing a need or opportunity for change? Evidence you have gathered should be included to support the cause and effect of each identified issue. Include any relevant dependencies or timeframes.

Options

Options include possible actions to address the issues that the business case seeks to address. It is common for business cases to cover at least three options (where available):

- no change and the risks involved with not making change.
- other options considered and the reasons why not recommended.
- recommended option and why this should be implemented.

For each viable option you wish to include in your business case you should outline the following for each:

What - Detail what the proposal entails such as deployment to new locations, job reductions, major alterations to current services or delivery arrangement

Benefits - Detail what enhanced service, efficiency, or effectiveness as a consequence of the proposed change will be delivered once the change has been addressed.

Implications - Focuses on any envisaged financial, economic or social impacts, primarily:

- are there any costs associated with the proposal?
- will the proposal enable savings or what additional funds will the proposal or initiative bring to the agency?
- any major social or economic implications, particularly regional and rural centres.

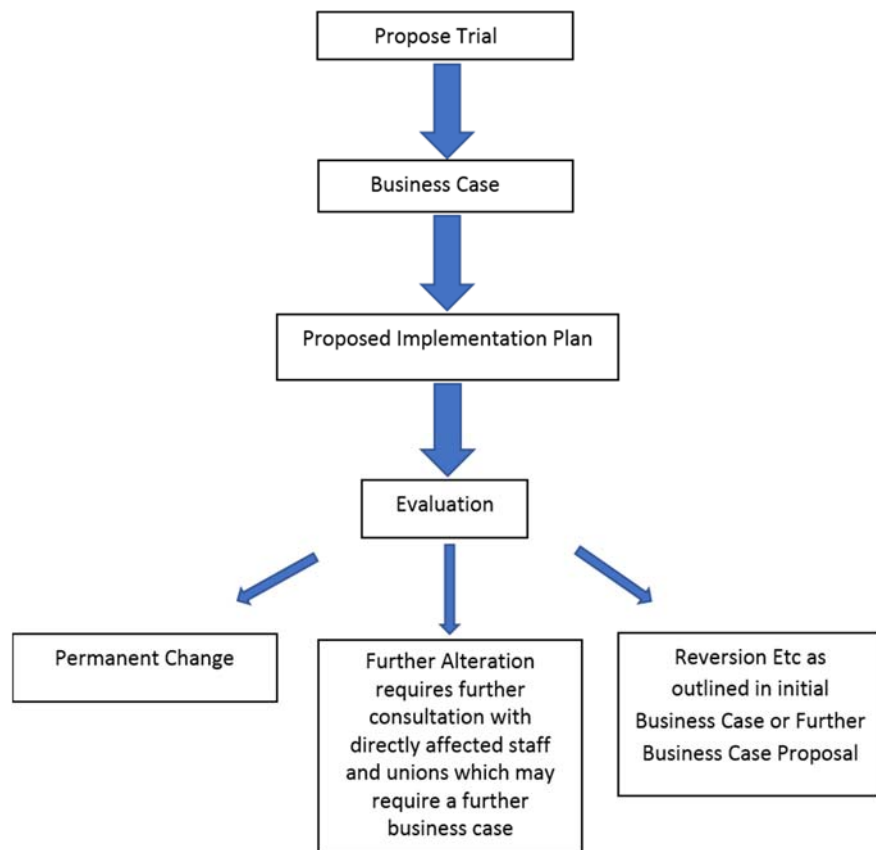
Risks - There will be two types of risk that the business case will need to cover:

- the additional risks associated with each proposal or initiative.
- the risks that each proposal or initiative will mitigate.

The business case should provide a critique why the recommended option/s are the most suitable course of action for the organisation and employees when considering the issue, options, implications and risks.

Trials

Trials may be undertaken for a specific period (or task) and are not permanent. Changes proposed on a trial basis are subject to the same consultation obligations as those being proposed on a permanent basis. A business case proposing a trial should outline how and when a trial is to be evaluated and what is to occur at the conclusion of the trial.



Next Steps

- consultation considerations - establish formal consultation and communication processes which involve representatives of all stakeholder groups.
- develop a consultation timeline allowing adequate time for representatives to consider and express their views. Collaborative efforts will maximise the quality and the beneficial outcomes of the change process.
- details of the proposed change be provided to employees to encourage participation.
- providing timeframes for the recommended option/s can be a useful tool in highlighting key milestones of the proposed change process.
- business cases must be tabled for consultation at the respective Hospital and Health Service Consultative Forums or equivalent (Previously named District Consultative Forums DCF's).
- following the business case process, a decision shall be made. A decision to initiate change/s requires the establishment of a formal implementation process including the distribution of implementation plan documentation and observing further consultative obligations.

Appendix 2

Business case for significant change Organisational change

Example Business case for significant change

[#Organisational Unit], [#HHS/Division/Branch]

Note: The business case template is available in word version on QHEPS at:

<https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/employment-conditions/change-management-guidelines>

1. Purpose of Business Case

This document provides an overview of the business case for the proposed reorganisation of the [#Organisational Unit], [#HHS/Division/Branch]. It is intended to support consultation in relation to the proposed changes and invites feedback from affected employees and relevant unions on these proposed changes.

The [#Organisational Unit], [#HHS/Division/Branch] is proposing change in accordance with government policy and relevant industrial obligations.

2. Background

The introduction/background describes the history and current situation related to the issue or opportunity. The purpose is to provide direction at the beginning of the document about what the proposal will achieve if the business case is supported. It should include, where possible, quantifiable data such service delivery expectations, costings, legislative changes or summary of current business processes.

3. Reason for change

Demonstrate the reason for change with sufficient detail including:

Why is a change required? What factors are influencing a need or opportunity for change? Information you have gathered should be included to support the cause and effect of each identified issue. Include any relevant dependencies or timeframes.

4. Options

Options include possible actions to address the issues that the business case seeks to address. It is common for business cases to cover at least three options (where available):

- 1. No change and the risks involved with not making change*
- 2. Recommended option and why this should be implemented including benefits such as enhanced service delivery to the community, or improved efficiency and effectiveness.*
- 3. An option or several options which could be implemented which are not recommended and the reasons why.*

Risks - There will be two types of risk that the business case will need to cover:

- The additional risks associated with each proposal or initiative
- The risks that each proposal or initiative will mitigate

Option 1 – No change

What	- xxxx
Benefits	- Nil additional benefits
Implications	- Xxx - xxx
Risks	- xxx

Option 2 – **xxxxxx** (Recommended)

What	- xxx
Benefits	- xxx (such as enhanced service delivery to the community, or improved efficiency and effectiveness) - xxx
Implications	- xxx - xxx
Risks	- xxx

(Note: The current and proposed organisational structures in Option 2 are attached)

Include additional options as required.

5. Recommendation

The business case should provide a critique why the recommended option/s are the most suitable course of action for the organisation and employees when considering the issue, options, implications and risks.

It is recommended that Option 2 is progressed for the following reasons:

- xxx
- xxx
- xxx

6. Next Steps

The following steps will be followed:

Date	Activity
xxx	Meet with Organisational Unit staff to present Business Case for Change
xxx	Meet with relevant unions to present Business Case for Change
xxx	Provide Business Case for Change to xxx Consultative Forum
xxx	Consultation period for feedback on Business Case opens
xxx	Consultation period for feedback on Business Case closes
xxx	Feedback on the proposed change will be considered by xxx

If Option 1 is pursued then no further steps will be undertaken.

If Option 2 is pursued then the following is proposed:

- consultation on proposed implementation plan
- xxx *(provided brief details of what/when)*
- implementation of the proposed structure by xxx. *(provided indicative date)*

7. Supporting Employees through Change

We appreciate this may be a difficult time for affected employees. The following support activities are offered to support staff.

- encouragement to contact the Employee Assistance Service (EAS) on **1800 604 640**. This confidential service can be accessed through self-referral to OPTUM, the external EAP service provider. Services are available 24 hours a day, seven days a week, and 365 days a year, at no cost. Counselling services are available face to face or by telephone. Additional information available at: <http://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/eap/>
- availability of Organisational Unit management to support staff.

8. Feedback contacts

Stakeholders are invited to provide feedback by [insert date] regarding the business case.

Feedback may be provided to the following officers by email, phone or face to face:

Attachment 1: Current Organisational Structure

Includes classification levels, position titles, position number and reporting lines. (Employee's names are not included)

Attachment 2: – Proposed Organisational Structure

Includes classification levels, position titles, position number and reporting lines. (Employee's names are not included)

Appendix 3

A guide for preparing an implementation plan

Organisational change

Overview

A decision for change may be as a result of strategic or operational requirements and must be in accordance with the [Queensland Government's Employment Security Policy](https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy) (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/policy/employment-security-policy>). Following consideration of feedback on the proposed business case, management will make a final decision on whether to implement change in accordance with a proposed implementation plan.

There shall be no contracting out, leasing or outsourcing of operational services currently provided by operational stream employees (cl 6.4.2 [EB9](https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements)) (<https://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/policies-agreements-directives/awards-agreements>). Proposals to contract out other services are to address the reason for change and to be developed in accordance with Queensland Government's Employment Security Policy by demonstrating clear benefits and enhanced service delivery.

The purpose of the proposed implementation plan is to consult with staff and unions on the workforce implementation for the organisational change. For successful implementation of any change it is critical for staff to be engaged and kept informed on the process. Unions may assist in seeing staff interests are being met, as well as facilitating effective communication and reducing possible staff concerns and objections.

During a specified period of consultation, directly affected employees and relevant unions will be provided with the opportunity to give feedback on the implementation plan, the likely effect of change on employees, including ways to avoid or minimise the impact of change/s in accordance with Termination Change and Redundancy (TCR) provisions within award/s.

This feedback will be considered as part of the change process and incorporated where necessary. If issues relating to the change process arise and are unable to be resolved locally they can be escalated through to peak consultative forums contained in relevant agreements.

As part of the consultation process managers must prepare the following mandatory documents:

- current organisational structure, which identifies numbers and classifications of employees engaged.
- new organisational structure, showing numbers and classifications of employees in the future.
- affected positions spreadsheet listing those positions (classifications and numbers) likely to be affected under the organisational change/s. The effects on employees may include position/s no longer being required, or a change in the number of positions at a particular classification level, or significant change in the functions/duties of the role or transfer of employees upon transfer of business.

- proposed change management plan including a timetable for implementation of the organisational change/s in its entirety.
- list of Affected Staff will be provided to the relevant unions so consultation can occur with those affected staff.

Who requires a copy of the Proposed Implementation Plan?

A copy of a proposed implementation plan is to be made available to those directly affected employees and relevant unions for consultation. During a specified period of consultation, affected employees and relevant unions will be provided the opportunity to provide feedback on the likely effects of the changes on employee/s, the period over which the change is to occur and ways to avoid or minimise the effects of the change.

Implementation Plan template – See Appendix 4 Implementation Plan Template.

Implementing Change

The strategies outlined below may be used for implementing organisational change.

Direct Matching (At Level)

Direct match may be used when an employee is being matched to a role of their current employment status and classification within the work unit/branch/division. Direct matched roles often have similar skills or functions and may be more specialised. Direct matching requires the provision of an evaluated job description of the intended matched role along with any developmental or training requirements to undertake the matched role.

Transfer at Level

Employee is transferred to a suitable role of the same status and classification level at another work unit or location. (Requires consideration of employee's circumstances).

Limited Applicant Pool Suitability Assessment (At Level)

Where the number and/or nature of ongoing roles change, the unit may adopt a limited applicant pool suitability assessment process to appoint employees to the new structure.

This often occurs where there are:

- mismatched numbers of staff to positions; or
- the role has changed such that it requires different skills; or
- employees may be considered for a suitable role within the revised structure.

New roles may require additional training and support for the employee. Any developmental or training requirements to undertake the new roles should also be outlined.

Voluntary Redundancy (VR) Expression of Interest (EOI)

Expressions of interest (EOI) of receiving a voluntary redundancy (VR) may be sought from the affected employees if an alternate role is not available or they may be interested in receiving such an invitation.

In expressing an interest in a VR, the employee acknowledges their position will no longer exist if they accept an offer. Management reserves the right to not make or not accept a VR EOI, or pursue an alternate strategy if the position is required to meet ongoing operational and service delivery needs.

Voluntary Redundancy Offer

Where alternate employment is required, support, advice and assistance will be provided to facilitate transition to new employment opportunities. Alternate placement options including transfer, redeployment, secondment or priority transfer within health or other public service roles must be explored prior to redundancy packages being offered. ([Directive 04/18](#) Cl. 10.1)

(<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/directive/0418/early-retirement-redundancy-and-retrenchment>).

In the event the employee declines the VR offer, that employee will then be required to participate in the priority transfer process as per clause 11.4 of [Directive No. 17/16](#) (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/directive/1716/supporting-employees-affected-workplace-change>). Public Service Commission Chief Executive Directive: Supporting employees affected by workplace change.

Priority Transfers (SEAWC – Previously ERP)

Where management is unable to facilitate the placement of the employee into a suitable alternative role, the employee is to be registered for a priority transfer ([Directive No. 17/16](#)) (<https://www.forgov.qld.gov.au/documents/directive/1716/supporting-employees-affected-workplace-change>). A priority transfer employee will be required to actively participate in the placement process including retraining or development to secure a transfer or consensual redeployment opportunities.

Timeframes

Proposed and finalised implementation plans are to include a timetable for implementation of the change/s, commencing from the time the decision of change is announced and including planned

communications. The implementation timetable is to include all various steps in the implementation plan, their proposed timeframes, and the responsible officer.

Post Consultation – Finalising the Implementation Plan

Following consideration of employee and union feedback through the consultation process, management will make a final decision on the implementation plan communicate the outcome and proceed to implement the organisational change/s. It is important to provide evidence to demonstrate the feedback was considered as part of this process.

The final plan should include the final versions of the following documents (where relevant):

- current and future structures.
- process to achieve the future structure.
- affected positions.
- options of support for employees.
- communication process for staff.
- timeframes for implementation.

Management should meet with each employee individually where it has been determined that the individual will be directly affected by the change/s. Employees should be afforded the opportunity to have a support person (including union representative) present. Consultation documents include a copy of the proposed implementation plan and advice on avenues of support (e.g. Employee Assistance Service).

Where affected employees are on leave, management will make their best endeavours to ensure this information is communicated to absent employees.

Implementing Change

- consideration should be given to setting up a dedicated intranet site and other communication forums to keep affected (and interested) employees informed of developments in the implementation of the announced decisions. You may include a Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) section to inform employees about matters they might be expected to ask about.
- consultation should be respectful and take into account cultural and language differences. Where information is provided and feedback is sought, always ensure this is accompanied by reasonable timeframes that allow the opportunity for genuine feedback to be provided.
- unions may assist in seeing staff interests are being met, as well as facilitating effective communication and reducing possible staff concerns and objections. Consultation periods should allow sufficient time for unions to meet with staff.

- managers meeting with individual employees and informing them of the impact of the change/s need to be briefed beforehand about their role. In this respect it is recommended that these managers be provided with talking points to ensure consistency of communication.
- all feedback should be reasonably considered and a response provided. It is important to demonstrate the feedback was considered as part of this process and the reasons for acceptance or rejection of feedback.
- it is suggested that a designated officer is assigned responsibility for contacting people who are absent or on leave from the workplace.

Offers of voluntary redundancy require approval by the appropriate delegate namely:

Department of Health	Director-General Deputy Director-General Corporate Services Chief Human Resource Officer General Manager, People, Performance and Excellence (HSQ) Executive Director Corporate Services eHealth Qld
Prescribed HHS's	Health Service Chief Executive
Non-Prescribed HHS's	Director-General Deputy Director-General Corporate Services Health Service Chief Executive

Appendix 4

Proposed implementation plan template

Organisational change

Proposed implementation plan

[#Organisational Unit], [# HHS/Division/Branch]

1. Purpose of Implementation Plan

This document provides an overview of the implementation process for the [#reorganisation/restructure/transfer of business] of the [#organisational unit] within [#HHS/Division/Branch].

This document supports the consultation process and invites feedback from affected employees and relevant unions in accordance with government policy and relevant industrial obligations.

On [date] a Business Case for Change was presented to [#organisational unit] and relevant unions for the [#reorganisation/restructure/transfer of business] of the [#organisational unit]. The Consultation period on the Business Case has closed and feedback was considered.

Include comment how feedback was reasonably considered.

A table of feedback and responses may also be included as an Attachment to the Proposed Implementation Plan.

2. Organisational Change

The [#Organisational unit] within [#HHS/Division/Branch] will be subject to a [#restructure/transfer of business] which is likely to have a significant effect upon employees.

The current organisational structure and proposed [#restructure/transfer of business] are available from

[# assigned change manager, email and telephone contact; or attached; or the intranet site].

It is anticipated that the organisational change/s will directly impact upon [# number of affected positions by FTE] full-time equivalent (FTE) positions in the following employment categories:

- [# affected FTE by generic role and employment status i.e. permanent or temporary].

An overview of the change is provided across the following categories: *(Remove irrelevant impacts)*

- Role/s discontinued and an/xx employee/s to become priority transfer employees
- Change in location to xxx for xx employee/s
- An/xx employee/s direct matched
- An/xx employee/s suitability assessed against xx new roles
- A/Xx New position/s –Open merit recruitment after checking against current priority transfer employees
- Change in reporting line for xx employee/s
- No change for xx employee/s

(Consider insertion of table of categories above, detailing affected positions and proposed action)

A list of positions in the unit that are likely to be directly affected is provided below and is also available from

[# assigned change manager, email and telephone contact].

3. Steps for Implementation

The following steps will be followed in implementing the organisational change/s:

1. Management makes an organisational change decision.
2. Management consults with directly affected employees and unions in relation to the change/s, its likely effects, implementation plans and ways to avoid or minimise effects of the change in accordance with TCR provisions. During this consultation, relevant documentation will be made available to employees and relevant unions.
3. Management will provide organisational change details to those employees likely to be directly affected and relevant unions in accordance with TCR provisions. Where affected employees are on leave, management will make their best endeavours to communicate with the absent employee.
4. During a specified period of consultation, directly affected employees and relevant unions will be consulted on the implementation of the change/s, the likely effect of change on employees and ways to avoid or minimise the effects of the change/s.
5. Following consideration of employee and union feedback through the consultation process, management will make a final decision on the implementation plan and proceed to implement, the organisational change/s.
6. Individual meetings will be held with directly affected employees to advise of the final decision and its impact on their position and to offer avenues of support through the process. Where directly affected employees are on leave, management will make contact with affected absent employees.
7. *One or more of the strategies A-F on page 2 must be utilised (apply as appropriate to circumstances)*
8. Management finalises the change/s.

One or more of the following strategies for implementation of organisational change/s must be utilised (apply as appropriate to circumstances at step 6 and remove irrelevant strategies and headings).

Strategy A.

Priority Transfer

Where management is unable to facilitate the placement of the employee into a suitable alternative role, the employee is to be registered for a priority transfer. A priority transfer employee will be required to actively participate in the placement process including retraining or development to secure a [#transfer/ or consensual redeployment] opportunities.

Strategy B.

Voluntary Redundancy (VR) Expression of Interest (EOI)

Expressions of interest (EOI) of receiving a voluntary redundancy (VR) may be sought from the affected employees if an alternate role is not available or they may be interested in receiving such an invitation.

In expressing an interest in a VR, the employee acknowledges their position will no longer exist if they accept an offer. Management reserves the right to not make or not accept a VR EOI, or pursue an alternate strategy if the position is required to meet ongoing operational and service delivery needs.

Strategy C.

VR Offer

Alternate placement options including transfer, redeployment, secondment or priority transfer within health or other public service roles **must be explored prior** to redundancy packages being offered. (Dir 04/18 Cl. 10.1)

In the event the employee declines the VR offer, that employee will then be required to participate in the priority transfer process (Clause 11.4 of Directive No. 17/16, Public Service Commission Chief Executive Directive: Supporting employees affected by workplace change).

Strategy D.

Limited Applicant Pool

Suitability Assessment (At level)

Where the number and/or nature of ongoing roles change, the unit may adopt a limited applicant pool suitability assessment process to appoint employees to the new structure.

This often occurs where there are:

- mismatched numbers of staff to positions; or
- the role has changed such that it requires different skills; or
- employees may be considered for a suitable role within the revised structure.

New roles may require additional training and support for the employee. Any developmental or training requirements to undertake the new roles should also be outlined.

Strategy E.

Direct Match

(At level)

Direct match may be used when an employee is being matched to a role of their current employment status and classification within the work unit/branch/division. Direct matched roles often have similar skills or functions and may be more specialised. Eg. Generalist HR role matched to Conduct and Performance. Direct matching requires the provision of an evaluated job description of the intended matched role along with any developmental or training requirements to undertake the matched role.

Strategy F.

Transfer at Level

Employee is transferred to a suitable role of the same status and classification level at another work unit or location. (Requires consideration of employee's circumstances).

4. Supporting Employees through Change

We appreciate this is a difficult time for affected employees. For employees whose roles may be affected by the proposal, the support offered includes:

- Individual discussions to provide accurate, up-to-date information on the change/s and the likely impact of the change on employees as early as possible in the process;
- Encouragement to utilise the Employee Assistance Program (EAP) on 1800 604 640 or online at <https://www.livewell.optum.com/member/default.asp> should the employee require professional support through the organisational change;

Consider other strategies such as: (remove irrelevant strategies):

- Resume writing and job interview skills training;
- Arrangement of group superannuation advice.

5. Timeline for implementing change

Note: The below text is provided as an example only.

Date/s	Action	Responsible Officer
	[#Eg. Decision made about the organisational change]	
	[#Eg. Meeting with staff to announce changes and commence consultation]	
	[#Eg. Meeting with unions to announce changes and table all relevant documentation for commencement of consultation.]	
	[Eg. Transition QHEPS page updated with relevant documentation]	
	[#Eg. Individual meetings held with all directly affected staff]	

Date/s	Action	Responsible Officer
	[Eg. Consultation period concludes, and all feedback considered]	
	[Eg. Implementation Plan finalised. Implementation to commence]	
	[#Detail all various steps in the implementation plan, their proposed timeframes, and the responsible officer. Eg. Commencement and conclusion of limited applicant pool suitability assessment processes, notifications of outcomes of limited applicant pool suitability assessment processes, QSuper information sessions, resume/interview workshops, etc.]	
	[#...]	
	[#...]	
	[#...]	
	[#...]	
	[#...]	
	[#...]	
	[#New structure fully implemented]	

6. Providing feedback

Stakeholders are invited to provide feedback by [#insert date] about the implementation process. Feedback may be provided by [#insert methods – i.e. phone, mail, email, etc.]:

Email [#email address]

Phone [#phone number]

Mail [#postal address]

Attachment 1 – Summary of the effects of the changes

Stream	Organisational Unit	Reductions in FTE	Impacted Staff	Occupancy Status
Administrative				Occupied
				Vacant
Building, Engineering & Maintenance				Occupied
				Vacant
Dental				Occupied
				Vacant
Health Practitioner				Occupied
				Vacant
Medical				Occupied
				Vacant
Nursing				Occupied
				Vacant
Operational				Occupied
				Vacant
Professional				Occupied
				Vacant
Technical				Occupied
				Vacant
Senior Officer/ District Senior Officer				Occupied
				Vacant
Senior Executive/ Health Service Executive				Occupied
				Vacant
Total			Occupied	
			Vacant	

Appendix 5

Affected Positions spreadsheet: [#Organisational Unit, HHS]

This spreadsheet is available in excel format on QHEPS at:

<https://gheps.health.qld.gov.au/hr/employment-conditions/change-management-guidelines/>

	ABOLISHED / RELOCATED POSITIONS						
Position Title	Position Number	Organisational Unit	Work Location	Classification	FTE	Comments	
	DIRECT MATCH						
Original Role	Position Number	Organisational Unit	Work Location	Classification	New Role	Classification	Comments

	LIMITED POOL SUITABILITY ASSESSMENT						
Position Title	Position Number	Organisational Unit	Work Location	Classification	Existing or New Position	Applicant Pool	Comments
	OPEN MERIT						
Position Title	Position Number	Organisational Unit	Work Location	Classification	Recruitment Strategy	New Position	Comments
	TRANSFER OF BUSINESS						
Position Title	Position Number	Organisational Unit	Work Location	Classification	Receiving Area		Comments

Direct Matching (At Level)

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In the event the employee declines the VR offer, that employee will then be required to participate in the priority transfer process as per clause 11.4 of Directive No. 17/16.

Priority Transfers

Where management is unable to facilitate the placement of the employee into a suitable alternative role, the employee is to be registered for a priority transfer. A priority transfer employee will be required to actively participate in the placement process including retraining or development to secure a [#transfer/ or consensual redeployment] opportunities.